看取り：そばに いる

End-of-Life Care — Stay Close, Keep Talking to Her — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Support a resident at the end of life and her family: greet her even when she cannot answer, keep your voice low, invite the family to talk to her and sit close, say only what you have seen, stay with a grieving question instead of answering it, and report every change at once.

1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

Daughter (visitor)

母は 聞こえて いますか。

Can my mother hear us?

Why: The question families ask most. She cannot tell by looking, and she is afraid of saying the wrong thing in front of her mother.

Hana (caregiver)

聞こえて いると 思います。

I believe she can hear you.

Why: Care staff are taught that hearing is one of the last senses to fade. Say it gently, as what you believe, not as a medical promise.

Hana (caregiver)

お声を かけて ください。

Please talk to her.

Why: THE RULE OF THIS EPISODE, first half. Give the family something to DO. Many sit in silence for fear of upsetting her, and being told they may speak is often what they remember afterwards.

Daughter (visitor)

お母さん、来たよ。

Mum, I'm here.

Why: She speaks to her mother the way she always has, in plain family speech. This is not your conversation — step back half a pace and let it happen.

Hana (caregiver)

どうぞ、そばに 座って ください。

Please, sit close to her.

Why: Bring the chair right up to the bed, near her head, where the daughter can hold her hand. Being close is most of what this care is.

Daughter (visitor)

母は 痛く ないですか。

Is my mother in pain?

Why: The fear under every other fear. Do not answer it from the doorway — go and look at her face and her breathing first.

Hana (caregiver)

今(いま)は 落(お)ち着(つ)いて いらっしゃいます。

Right now she seems settled.

Why: Say what you have SEEN — calm breathing, a relaxed face — and say 今(いま)は, right now. いらっしゃる because you are speaking to her family about her (Ep 11).

Hana (caregiver)

看護師(かんごし)にも 伝(つた)えますね。

I'll tell the nurse as well.

Why: A question about pain goes to the nurse every time, even when she looks calm. Say that you are doing it, so the daughter is not left wondering.

Daughter (visitor)

もう、だめなんでしょうか。

Is this the end, then?

Why: The hardest question you will be asked. You are not the one who answers it — the doctor and nurse speak about what comes next. Your job is to stay with her feeling.

Hana (caregiver)

つらいですね。

This is so hard.

Why: THE RULE, second half. Name the feeling and stop. Do not fill the silence with facts or cheer — a few quiet seconds beside her say more than any sentence.

Hana (caregiver)

私(わたし)も そばに いますね。

I'm here with you too.

Why: You are here for the daughter as much as for her mother. Stay a moment — then step out and give the family the room.

Hana (caregiver)

何(なに)か あったら、すぐ 呼(よ)んで ください。

If anything changes, call me straight away.

Why: Put the call button in her hand. Breathing and colour can change quickly, and the family must never feel they are bothering you.

Daughter (visitor)

ありがとうございます。

Thank you.

Why: She is not thanking you for a task. She is thanking you for not leaving her alone with the question.

Hana (caregiver)

田中(たなか)さん、娘(むすめ)さんが いますよ。

Tanaka-san, your daughter is here.

Why: Before you leave, speak to Tanaka-san herself and tell her who is with her. Everything in this room is said TO her, never about her over her head.

Hana (caregiver)

今日(きょう)の 様子(ようす)は、すぐ 報告(ほうこく)します。

I'll report how she is today straight away.

Why: Breathing, colour, whether she swallowed, what the family asked — the nurse and the next shift need all of it. In these last days, small changes are the whole record.

2 · Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES
1	母(はは)	*haha*	(my own) mother	
2	聞(き)こえる	*kikoeru*	to be able to hear; be heard (recycled from Ep 24)	
3	声(こえ)を かける	*koeokakeru*	to speak to someone (recycled from Ep 23)	
4	お母(かあ)さん	*okaasan*	Mum; mother (calling her)	
5	そば	*soba*	close by; at someone's side (recycled from Ep 23)	
6	座(すわ)る	*suwaru*	to sit	
7	痛(いた)い	*itai*	painful; it hurts	
8	落(お)ち着(つ)く	*ochitsuku*	to settle; be calm	
9	看護師(かんごし)	*kangoshi*	nurse	
10	伝(つた)える	*tsutaeru*	to tell; pass on	
11	つらい	*tsurai*	hard; painful (emotionally)	
12	呼(よ)ぶ	*yobu*	to call (someone)	
13	娘(むすめ)	*musume*	daughter	
14	様子(ようす)	*yousu*	condition; how someone is	
15	報告(ほうこく)する	*houkokusuru*	to report (recycled from Ep 24)	

3 · Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE

お声を かけて ください	Invite the family to talk to her
今は 落ち着いて いらっしゃいます	Say only what you have seen, and say right now
つらいですね	Stay with the feeling — do not answer how long
私も そばに いますね	Be present for the family too
今日の 様子は、すぐ 報告します	In the last days, every change is reported at once

4 · Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	What does the daughter ask first? A) 母は 聞こえて いますか B) 母は 食べましたか C) 母は 寝て いますか D) 母は どこですか	
2	Who will Hana tell about the pain question? A) ご家族 B) 看護師 C) 娘さん D) 田中さん	
3	Invite the daughter to talk to her mother.	
4	Tell the daughter you are here with her too.	
5	Tell her to call you straight away if anything changes.	

5 · Answer Key — こたえ

1. 母は 聞こえて いますか。
2. 看護師にも 伝えますね。
3. お声を かけて ください。
4. 私も そばに いますね。
5. 何か あったら、すぐ 呼んで ください。